

Introduction:

The real number system had limitations that were at first accepted and later overcome by a series of improvements in both concepts and mechanics. In connection with quadratic equations, we encountered the concept of imaginary number and the device invented for handling it, the notation

$$i^2 = -1 \text{ or } i = \sqrt{-1}$$

In this lecture we continue the extension of the real number system to include imaginary' numbers. The extended system is called the complex number system.

Complex Number

A complex number is a number of the form $a + bi$, where a and b are real and $i^2 = -1$ or $i = \sqrt{-1}$. The letter ' a ' is called the real part and ' b ' is called the imaginary part of $a + bi$. If $a = 0$, the number bi is said to be a purely imaginary number and if $b = 0$, the number a is real number. Hence, real numbers and pure imaginary numbers are special cases of complex numbers. The complex numbers are denoted by Z , i.e.,

$$Z = a + bi$$

In coordinate form $Z = (a, b)$

Note: Every real number is a complex number with 0 as its imaginary part.

Note: Electrical engineers often write j instead of i because current is usually denoted by i .

Properties of Complex Number:

- (i) The two complex numbers $a + bi$ and $c + di$ are equal if and only if $a = c$ and $b = d$ for example if

$$x - 2 + 4yi = 3 + 12i$$

$$\text{Then } x - 2 = 3 \text{ and } y = 3$$

- (ii) If any complex number vanishes then its real and imaginary parts will separately vanish.

For example, if

$$a + bi = 0 \text{ then } a = -bi$$

Squaring both sides

$$a^2 = -b^2 \text{ or } a^2 + b^2 = 0$$

Which is possible only when $a = 0, b = 0$.

Basic Algebraic Operation on Complex Numbers

There are four algebraic operations on complex numbers

(i) Addition:

$$\text{If } Z_1 = a_1 + b_1i \text{ and } Z_2 = a_2 + b_2i \text{ then}$$

$$Z_1 + Z_2 = (a_1 + b_1i) + (a_2 + b_2i) = (a_1 + a_2) + i(b_1 + b_2)$$

(ii) Subtraction:

$$\text{If } Z_1 = a_1 + b_1i \text{ and } Z_2 = a_2 + b_2i \text{ then}$$

$$Z_1 - Z_2 = (a_1 + b_1i) - (a_2 + b_2i) = (a_1 - a_2) + i(b_1 - b_2)$$

(iii) Multiplication:

$$\text{If } Z_1 = a_1 + b_1i \text{ and } Z_2 = a_2 + b_2i \text{ then}$$

$$Z_1 Z_2 = (a_1 + b_1i) \cdot (a_2 + b_2i) = a_1a_2 + a_1b_2i + b_1a_2i + (b_1b_2)i^2$$

$$Z_1 Z_2 = a_1a_2 - b_1b_2 + i(a_1b_2 + b_1a_2)$$

(iv) Division:

$$\frac{Z_1}{Z_2} = \frac{a_1 + b_1i}{a_2 + b_2i}$$

Multiply Numerator and denominator by the number $(a_2 - b_2i)$ in order to make the denominator real.

$$\frac{Z_1}{Z_2} = \frac{a_1 + b_1i}{a_2 + b_2i} \times \frac{a_2 - b_2i}{a_2 - b_2i} = \frac{a_1a_2 + b_1b_2 + i(b_1a_2 - a_1b_2)}{a_2^2 + b_2^2 + i(a_2b_2 - a_2b_2)}$$

$$\frac{Z_1}{Z_2} = \frac{a_1a_2 + b_1b_2 + i(b_1a_2 - a_1b_2)}{a_2^2 + b_2^2} = \frac{a_1a_2 + b_1b_2}{a_2^2 + b_2^2} + i \frac{(b_1a_2 - a_1b_2)}{a_2^2 + b_2^2}$$

Generally, result will be expressed in the form $a + ib$.

Examples:

If $Z_1 = 8 + 3i$ and $Z_2 = 9 - 2i$

Find $(Z_1 + Z_2)$, $(Z_1 - Z_2)$, $(Z_1 \cdot Z_2)$ and $(\frac{Z_1}{Z_2})$

Sol.

1. $Z_1 + Z_2 = 17 + i$

2. $Z_1 - Z_2 = -1 + 5i$

3. $Z_1 \cdot Z_2 = (72 + 6) + i(-16 + 27) = 78 + 11i$

4. $\frac{Z_1}{Z_2} = \frac{8+3i}{9-2i} = \frac{8+3i}{9-2i} \times \frac{9+2i}{9+2i} = \frac{72-6+27i+16i}{81+4} = \frac{66}{85} + \frac{43}{85}i$

Find the values of the following:

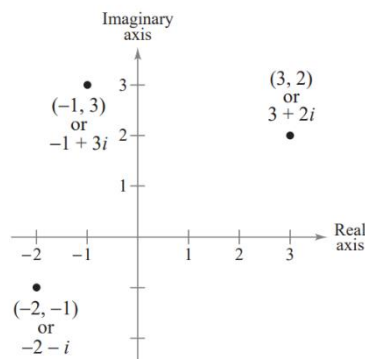
1. $\frac{1+5i}{-3i}$ 2. $\frac{7-i}{2+10i}$ 3. $2i + (-8 - 15i)$ 4. $(6 + 2i)^2$ 5. $4 - (3 - 20i)$

6. $(10 + 3i)(-1 + 7i)$

Polar Form of a Complex Number

Just as real numbers can be represented by points on the real number line, you can represent a complex number $Z = a + bi$

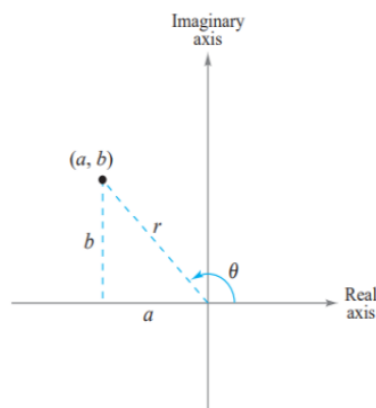
at the point (a,b) in a coordinate plane (the **complex plane**). The horizontal axis is called the **real axis** and the vertical axis is called the **imaginary axis**, as shown in figure below.



The **absolute value** of the complex number $a+bi$ is defined as the distance between the origin $(0,0)$ and the point (a,b) and is calculated as follows:

$$|a + bi| = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$$

To work effectively with *powers and roots* of complex numbers, it is helpful to write complex numbers in **polar form**. In the figure below, consider the nonzero complex number $a+bi$



By letting θ be the angle from the positive x -axis (measured counter-clockwise) to the line segment connecting the origin and the point (a,b) you can write

$$a = r \cos \theta \text{ and } b = r \sin \theta$$

$$\text{where } r = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$$

from which you can obtain the **polar form** of a complex number.

Consequently, you have

$$Z = a + bi = (r \cos \theta) + (r \sin \theta)i = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$$

$$\tan \theta = \frac{b}{a}$$

The number r is the **modulus** of Z , and θ is called an **argument** of Z .

NOTE The polar form of a complex number is also called the **trigonometric form**. Because there are infinitely many choices for θ , the polar form of a complex number is not unique. Normally, θ is restricted to the interval

$$0 \leq \theta < 2\pi$$

although on occasion it is convenient to use $\theta < 0$.

Example:

Write the following complex number in polar form

$$Z = -2 - 2\sqrt{3}i$$

Sol.

$$\text{Since } Z = a + bi = -2 - 2\sqrt{3}i \text{ then } a = -2 \text{ and } b = -2\sqrt{3}$$

The absolute value of Z is

$$r = |a + bi| = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2} = \sqrt{4 + 12} = 4$$

And the angle θ is given by

$$\tan \theta = \frac{b}{a} = \frac{-2\sqrt{3}}{-2} = \sqrt{3}$$

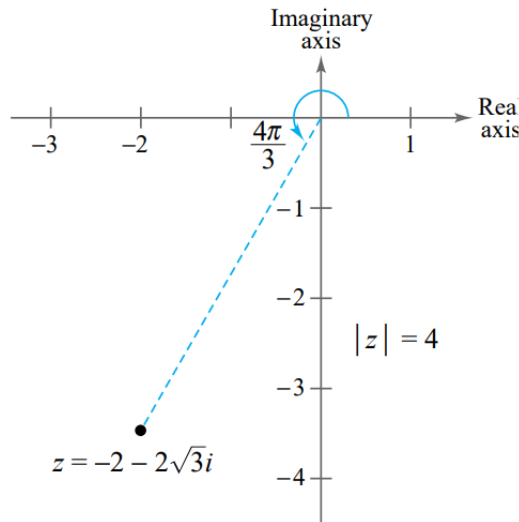
$$\tan \frac{\pi}{3} = \sqrt{3}$$

Because $Z = -2 - 2\sqrt{3}i$ lies in Quadrant III, then

$$\theta = \pi + \frac{\pi}{3} = \frac{4}{3}\pi$$

And the polar form of the given complex number will be

$$Z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta) = 4(\cos \frac{4}{3}\pi + i \sin \frac{4}{3}\pi)$$



Multiplication and Division of Complex Numbers in the Polar Form

The polar form adapts nicely to multiplication and division of complex numbers.

Suppose you are given two complex numbers

$$Z_1 = r_1(\cos \theta_1 + i \sin \theta_1) \text{ and } Z_2 = r_2(\cos \theta_2 + i \sin \theta_2)$$

The product of Z_1 and Z_2 will be

$$Z_1 Z_2 = r_1 r_2 (\cos \theta_1 + i \sin \theta_1) (\cos \theta_2 + i \sin \theta_2) =$$

$$Z_1 Z_2 = r_1 r_2 [(\cos \theta_1 \cos \theta_2 - \sin \theta_1 \sin \theta_2) + i (\sin \theta_1 \cos \theta_2 + \cos \theta_1 \sin \theta_2)]$$

Using the sum and difference formulas for cosine and sine, you can rewrite this equation as

$$Z_1 Z_2 = r_1 r_2 [\cos (\theta_1 + \theta_2) + i \sin (\theta_1 + \theta_2)]$$

In the same manner the Quotient of Z_1 and Z_2 will be

$$\frac{Z_1}{Z_2} = \frac{r_1}{r_2} [\cos (\theta_1 - \theta_2) + i \sin (\theta_1 - \theta_2)], Z_2 \neq 0$$

Example

If $Z_1 = 2(\cos \frac{2\pi}{3} + i \sin \frac{2\pi}{3})$ and $Z_2 = 8(\cos \frac{11\pi}{6} + i \sin \frac{11\pi}{6})$

Find $(Z_1 \cdot Z_2)$

Sol.

$$Z_1 \cdot Z_2 = \left[2 \left(\cos \frac{2\pi}{3} + i \sin \frac{2\pi}{3} \right) \right] \left[8 \left(\cos \frac{11\pi}{6} + i \sin \frac{11\pi}{6} \right) \right]$$

$$Z_1 Z_2 = r_1 r_2 [\cos (\theta_1 + \theta_2) + i \sin (\theta_1 + \theta_2)]$$

$$Z_1 Z_2 = 16 \left[\cos \left(\frac{2\pi}{3} + \frac{11\pi}{6} \right) + i \sin \left(\frac{2\pi}{3} + \frac{11\pi}{6} \right) \right]$$

$$Z_1 Z_2 = 16 \left[\cos \left(\frac{5\pi}{2} \right) + i \sin \left(\frac{5\pi}{2} \right) \right] = 16 \left[\cos \left(\frac{\pi}{2} \right) + i \sin \left(\frac{\pi}{2} \right) \right]$$

$$Z_1 Z_2 = 16[0 + i] = 16i$$

Example

If $Z_1 = 24(\cos 300^\circ + i \sin 300^\circ)$ and $Z_2 = 8(\cos 75^\circ + i \sin 75^\circ)$

Find $\left(\frac{Z_1}{Z_2}\right)$

Sol.

$$\frac{Z_1}{Z_2} = \frac{r_1}{r_2} [\cos (\theta_1 - \theta_2) + i \sin (\theta_1 - \theta_2)] = \frac{24}{8} [\cos 225^\circ + i \sin 225^\circ]$$

$$\frac{Z_1}{Z_2} = 3 \left[\frac{-\sqrt{2}}{2} + i \frac{-\sqrt{2}}{2} \right] = \frac{-3\sqrt{2}}{2} - i \frac{3\sqrt{2}}{2}$$

Powers and Roots of Complex Numbers and DeMoivre's Theorem

To raise a complex number to a power, consider repeated use of the multiplication rule.

$$Z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$$

$$Z^2 = r^2(\cos 2\theta + i \sin 2\theta)$$

$$Z^3 = r^3(\cos 3\theta + i \sin 3\theta)$$

This pattern leads to the following important theorem, which is named after the French mathematician Abraham DeMoivre (1667–1754).

DeMoivre's Theorem

If $Z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$ is a complex number and n is a positive integer, then
 $Z^n = r^n(\cos n\theta + i \sin n\theta)$

Example

Use DeMoivre's Theorem to find

$$(-1 + \sqrt{3}i)^{12}$$

Sol.

$$(-1 + \sqrt{3}i)^{12} = r^{12}(\cos 12\theta + i \sin 12\theta)$$

The absolute value of Z is

$$r = |a + bi| = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2} = \sqrt{1 + 3} = 2$$

And the angle θ is given by

$$\tan \theta = \frac{b}{a} = \frac{-\sqrt{3}}{1} = -\sqrt{3}$$

$$\text{Since } \tan \frac{2\pi}{3} = -\sqrt{3} \text{ then } \theta = \frac{2\pi}{3}$$

$$-1 + \sqrt{3}i = 2 \left(\cos \frac{2\pi}{3} + i \sin \frac{2\pi}{3} \right)$$

$$(-1 + \sqrt{3}i)^{12} = 2^{12}(\cos 8\pi + i \sin 8\pi) = 4096$$

Definition of n th Root of a Complex Number

The complex number $u = a + bi$ is an n th root of the complex number z if

$$z = u^n = (a + bi)^n$$

To find a formula for an n th root of a complex number, let u be an n th root of z , where

$$u = s(\cos \beta + i \sin \beta) \text{ and } z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$$

By DeMoivre's Theorem and the fact $u^n = z$

$$s^n(\cos n\beta + i \sin n\beta) = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$$

Taking the absolute values of both sides of this equation, it follows that $s^n = r$

Substituting back into the previous equation and dividing by r , you get

$$(\cos n\beta + i \sin n\beta) = (\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$$

Thus, it follows that

$$\cos n\beta = \cos \theta \text{ and } \sin n\beta = \sin \theta$$

Because both sine and cosine have a period of 2π these last two equations have solutions if and only if the angles differ by a multiple of 2π . Consequently, there must exist an integer k such that

$$n\beta = \theta + 2\pi k$$

Or

$$\beta = \frac{\theta + 2\pi k}{n}$$

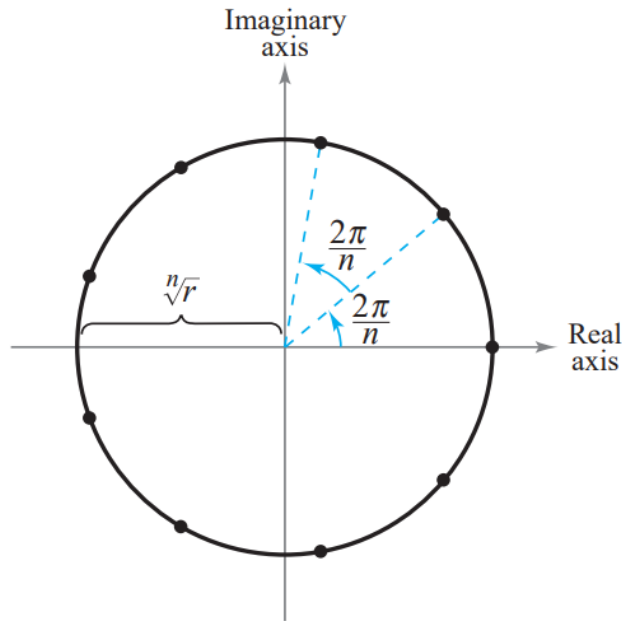
By substituting this value for β into the polar form of u , you get the following result:

THEOREM n th Roots of a Complex Number

For a positive integer n , the complex number $z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$ has exactly n distinct n th roots given by

$$\sqrt[n]{r} \left(\cos \frac{\theta + 2\pi k}{n} + i \sin \frac{\theta + 2\pi k}{n} \right) \text{ where } k = 0, 1, 2, \dots, n-1$$

This formula for the n th roots of a complex number z has a geometrical interpretation, as shown in the next Figure. Note that because the n th roots of z all have the same magnitude $\sqrt[n]{r}$ they all lie on a circle of radius $\sqrt[n]{r}$ with centre at the origin. Furthermore, because successive n th roots have arguments that differ by $\frac{2\pi}{n}$ the n roots are equally spaced along the circle.



Example

Find the three cube roots of

$$z = -2 + 2i$$

Solution Because z lies in Quadrant II, the polar form for z

$$z = -2 + 2i = \sqrt{8} (\cos 135^\circ + i \sin 135^\circ)$$

By the formula for n th roots, the cube roots have the form

$$\sqrt[3]{8} \left(\cos \frac{135^\circ + 360^\circ k}{3} + i \sin \frac{135^\circ + 360^\circ k}{3} \right) \text{ where } k = 0, 1, 2$$

Then for $k = 0$

$$\sqrt{2} (\cos 45^\circ + i \sin 45^\circ) = 1 + i$$

For $k = 1$

$$\sqrt{2} (\cos 165^\circ + i \sin 165^\circ) \approx -1.366 + 0.366i$$

For $k = 2$

$$\sqrt{2} (\cos 285^\circ + i \sin 285^\circ) \approx 0.366 - 1.366i$$

Argand Diagram

Euler's Formula

The identity

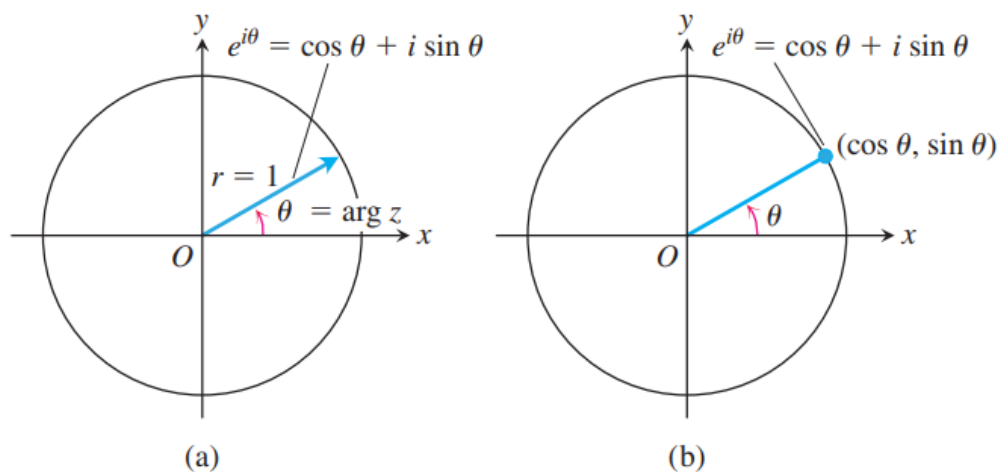
$$e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta$$

is called Euler's formula

Since $Z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$, the Euler's formula enables us to rewrite this equation as

$$Z = re^{i\theta}$$

This formula, in turn, leads to the following rules for calculating products, quotients, powers, and roots of complex numbers. It also leads to Argand diagrams for $e^{i\theta}$. By taking $r = 1$, we can say that $e^{i\theta}$ is represented by a unit vector that makes an angle θ with the positive x -axis, as shown in Figure below:



Products

To multiply two complex numbers, we multiply their absolute values and add their angles.

Let $z_1 = r_1 e^{i\theta_1}$ and $z_2 = r_2 e^{i\theta_2}$

$$|z_1| = r_1, \arg z_1 = \theta_1, |z_2| = r_2, \arg z_2 = \theta_2$$

$$z_1 z_2 = r_1 r_2 e^{i(\theta_1 + \theta_2)}$$

Example

If you know that

$$z_1 = \sqrt{2} e^{i\frac{\pi}{4}}, \quad z_2 = 2 e^{-i\frac{\pi}{6}}$$

Find $z_1 z_2$

Sol.

$$z_1 z_2 = r_1 r_2 e^{i(\theta_1 + \theta_2)} = 2\sqrt{2} e^{i(\frac{\pi}{4} - \frac{\pi}{6})} = 2\sqrt{2} e^{i\frac{\pi}{12}}$$

$$z_1 z_2 = 2\sqrt{2} \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{12} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{12} \right) \approx 2.73 + 0.73i$$

Quotients

Suppose $r_2 \neq 0$

$$\text{Then } \frac{z_1}{z_2} = \frac{r_1 e^{i\theta_1}}{r_2 e^{i\theta_2}} = \frac{r_1}{r_2} e^{i(\theta_1 - \theta_2)}$$

Example

If you know that

$$z_1 = 1 + i, \quad z_2 = \sqrt{3} - i$$

Find z_1 / z_2

Sol.

$$\left| \frac{z_1}{z_2} \right| = \frac{r_1}{r_2} e^{i(\theta_1 - \theta_2)}$$

$$Z_1 = 1 + i = r_1 e^{i\theta_1}$$

$$a = 1, b = 1, r_1 = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2} = \sqrt{2}$$

$$\frac{b}{a} = \tan \theta_1 = 1, \text{ then } \theta_1 = \frac{\pi}{4}$$

$$Z_1 = 1 + i = \sqrt{2} e^{i\frac{\pi}{4}}$$

$$Z_2 = \sqrt{3} - i = r_2 e^{i\theta_2}$$

$$a = \sqrt{3}, b = -1, r_2 = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2} = 2$$

$$\frac{b}{a} = \tan \theta_2 = \frac{-1}{\sqrt{3}}, \text{ then } \theta_2 = \frac{-\pi}{6}$$

$$Z_2 = \sqrt{3} - i = 2 e^{i\frac{-\pi}{6}}$$

$$\left| \frac{Z_1}{Z_2} \right| = \frac{r_1}{r_2} e^{i(\theta_1 - \theta_2)} = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} e^{i(\frac{\pi}{4} + \frac{\pi}{6})} = 0.707 e^{i\frac{5\pi}{12}}$$

$$0.707 e^{i\frac{5\pi}{12}} = 0.707 \left(\cos \frac{5\pi}{12} + i \sin \frac{5\pi}{12} \right)$$

$$\left| \frac{Z_1}{Z_2} \right| \approx 0.183 + 0.683 i$$

Powers

If (n) is a positive integer then

$$Z^n = Z.Z.Z \dots Z \quad n \text{ factors}$$

With

$$Z = r e^{i\theta}$$

Then

$$Z^n = (r e^{i\theta})^n = r^n e^{in\theta}$$

$$r^n e^{in\theta} = r^n (\cos n\theta + i \sin n\theta)$$

Example

If $Z = 4e^{i\frac{\pi}{3}}$

$n=3$

$$Z^3 = (re^{i\theta})^3 = r^3 e^{3i\theta} = 4^3 e^{i\pi}$$